



AP[®] United States Government and Politics Practice Exam

From the 2013 Administration

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UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

Section I

Time—45 minutes

60 Questions

Directions: Each of the questions or incomplete statements below is followed by five suggested answers or completions. Select the one that is best in each case and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

1. Congress adopted the War Powers Resolution to
 - (A) give the president additional powers in case of military emergencies
 - (B) delineate a clear chain of command in the event of nuclear war
 - (C) criticize the president for declaring war without authorization from Congress
 - (D) enable the president to commit troops to United Nations peacekeeping forces
 - (E) limit the president's authority to commit troops overseas
2. Which of the following types of committee deals with broad areas of public policy and can be found in both houses of Congress?
 - (A) Rules
 - (B) Select
 - (C) Joint
 - (D) Standing
 - (E) Conference
3. Which of the following explains why any attempt to reduce Social Security benefits is difficult?
 - (A) The Supreme Court has ruled that benefits are constitutionally required.
 - (B) Interest groups concerned with Social Security are ineffective.
 - (C) The global economy makes government insurance programs necessary.
 - (D) There are many voters who support Social Security.
 - (E) Government cannot predict the number of new retirees each year.
4. Which of the following describes the president's Cabinet?
 - (A) It consists of career civil servants with decades of experience in government service.
 - (B) Its members have varying levels of influence on presidential decisions.
 - (C) Its members hold office for fixed terms that coincide with the president's.
 - (D) Its members must be selected from among current or former members of Congress.
 - (E) Its members are required to approve presidential policy decisions.

5. The development and persistence of the two-party system in the United States is best accounted for by
 - (A) the Twelfth Amendment
 - (B) proportional representation
 - (C) multimember legislative districts
 - (D) single-member legislative districts
 - (E) strong party loyalty of elected representatives
6. The concept of realignment refers to changes in
 - (A) the United States system of international alliances
 - (B) the social bases of the parties' voting support
 - (C) the media's criticism of the president and Congress
 - (D) spending priorities in the federal budget
 - (E) the rate of voter participation
7. Much of the steady increase in federal government expenditures since 1960 has been caused by
 - (A) increases in entitlement programs
 - (B) higher interest rates caused by an increase in the discount rate
 - (C) the provisions of the Gramm-Rudman-Hollings Act
 - (D) increased purchases of United States government securities by foreign investors
 - (E) the growth of the United States trade imbalance
8. Establishing the boundaries of United States congressional districts to give one party an advantage over another party is referred to as
 - (A) raiding
 - (B) apportionment
 - (C) reapportionment
 - (D) gerrymandering
 - (E) filibustering
9. Congress is most likely to exert oversight of the executive bureaucracy in which of the following ways?
 - (A) Directly selecting the head of an executive agency
 - (B) Impeaching the head of an executive agency
 - (C) Using the Court to block implementation of proposed regulations
 - (D) Controlling an executive agency's annual budget
 - (E) Changing the term length of heads of independent regulatory commissions
10. Which of the following statements about voting behavior in national elections is most accurate?
 - (A) Men are more likely to vote than are women.
 - (B) Blue-collar workers are more likely to vote than are professionals.
 - (C) Those with less than a high school education are more likely to vote than are college graduates.
 - (D) Democrats are more likely to vote than are Republicans.
 - (E) Senior citizens are more likely to vote than are college students.
11. Which of the following best explains why the winner of a presidential election usually claims to have a mandate from voters?
 - (A) The president's party often wins a majority of seats in Congress by riding the president's coattails.
 - (B) The allocation of electoral votes in the winner-take-all system exaggerates the margin of victory.
 - (C) Presidents are allowed to implement their legislative agendas without interference during their first term.
 - (D) The new president is allowed to replace a significant number of justices on the Supreme Court.
 - (E) The incoming president automatically gains control of Congress.
12. Typically, presidential candidates implement their campaign strategies by
 - (A) applying their resources evenly among the states, because they must win popular votes in a majority of the states to be elected
 - (B) focusing on larger, competitive states, because they might tip the balance of the electoral college
 - (C) focusing on small states, because these states have proportionally more electoral votes than more populous states have
 - (D) ignoring the electoral college, because the popular vote determines the outcome of the election
 - (E) ignoring the electoral college, because more states are moving away from the winner-take-all system

13. The supremacy clause in the Constitution states that
- (A) federal law takes precedence over state law when the laws conflict
 - (B) only Congress may declare war
 - (C) the Senate should have a greater role in foreign affairs than does the House of Representatives
 - (D) the federal government has the right to regulate interstate commerce
 - (E) the Supreme Court has the power to overturn decisions of lower courts
14. A policy that sets emission standards for automobiles is an example of
- (A) regulatory policy
 - (B) judicial policy
 - (C) fiscal policy
 - (D) distributive policy
 - (E) monetary policy
15. The idea that judges ought to freely strike down laws that are inconsistent with their understanding of the Constitution is known as
- (A) original intent
 - (B) judicial restraint
 - (C) judicial activism
 - (D) judicial review
 - (E) stare decisis
16. Of the following, the most significant difference between the Constitution of 1787 and the Articles of Confederation was that the Constitution
- (A) made states sovereign over the national government, while the Articles were based on national sovereignty
 - (B) was difficult to amend, while the Articles included an easier process requiring approval by a simple majority of states
 - (C) provided for a presidential system of government, while the Articles provided for a parliamentary system of government
 - (D) created a dominant national executive, while the Articles established a dominant national legislature
 - (E) provided for a strong national government with many powers, while the Articles created a weak central government with few independent powers
17. The term “bicameralism” refers to the
- (A) establishment of two legislative chambers that have different structures and rules
 - (B) members of the House of Representatives having two-year terms
 - (C) president having veto power over both chambers of Congress
 - (D) members of the House and Senate having to appease their mutual constituencies
 - (E) checks that Congress has over the federal bureaucracy
18. Children are most likely to adopt the party identification
- (A) of their parents
 - (B) of the president
 - (C) of their friends
 - (D) of their teachers
 - (E) endorsed by the media
19. The media’s effect on public opinion can best be described as
- (A) influencing older citizens’ opinions of incumbents
 - (B) affecting the public’s views on domestic policy only
 - (C) influencing which issues the public sees as important
 - (D) changing well-educated people’s views on foreign policy
 - (E) influencing the public’s views on controversial issues only
20. When people vote for some candidates from one party and other candidates from another party, it is called
- (A) dealignment
 - (B) realignment
 - (C) republicanism
 - (D) ticket splitting
 - (E) caucusing

21. The doctrine of stare decisis is significant for which of the following reasons?
- (A) It establishes the jurisdiction of federal courts in litigation involving two or more states.
 - (B) It is the principle that affirms that courts are bound by prior decisions.
 - (C) It is the policy by which the Supreme Court decides which of the appellate cases it will hear.
 - (D) It directs states to provide a lawyer for people who cannot pay for their own legal defense.
 - (E) It holds high courts responsible for determining the constitutionality of proposed legislation before it becomes law.
22. The expansion of the executive branch since 1939 has affected the separation of powers by
- (A) increasing presidential control over the legislative process
 - (B) increasing the power of the media as a result of more frequent presidential press conferences
 - (C) reducing the power of the Supreme Court through the use of executive orders
 - (D) giving more power to interest groups than to parties
 - (E) making senatorial approval of presidential appointees ceremonial
23. The most significant trend in federal-state relations during the 1980s was
- (A) giving the federal government control over social welfare programs
 - (B) bringing about greater equality in the provision of social services in different states
 - (C) limiting state governments' ability to assess income taxes
 - (D) expanding the authority of county and municipal governments at the expense of state governments
 - (E) shifting the responsibilities and costs for many programs to state governments
24. Congress has the constitutional power to control the judicial branch by
- (A) determining the size of the Supreme Court
 - (B) nominating the chief justice of the Supreme Court
 - (C) limiting the length of judicial terms
 - (D) reducing the salary of judges while they are sitting
 - (E) altering the original jurisdiction of the Supreme Court
25. Which of the following is most important for getting an accurate measure of public opinion in a survey?
- (A) Surveying only cell phone users
 - (B) Selecting a random sample
 - (C) Asking leading questions
 - (D) Contacting only registered voters
 - (E) Conducting the survey online
26. Which of the following clauses in the Constitution justifies the "implied powers doctrine" ?
- (A) The necessary and proper clause
 - (B) The privileges and immunities clause
 - (C) The contract clause
 - (D) The debts and engagements clause
 - (E) The executive power clause
27. Interest groups use political action committees (PACs) to
- (A) provide expertise to members of Congress when they are writing legislation
 - (B) lobby the executive bureaucracy when they are considering new rules and regulations
 - (C) raise and spend money on election campaigns
 - (D) generate research that can be used to influence public opinion
 - (E) hire policy experts who will promote their views in the media

28. The United States Fish and Wildlife Service will spend money appropriated by Congress to maintain wildlife refuges. This action is an example of
- (A) the power of the filibuster
 - (B) congressional oversight of the bureaucracy
 - (C) bureaucratic implementation of law
 - (D) an unfunded mandate
 - (E) an independent expenditure
29. The framers of the Constitution designed which of the following to be LEAST responsive to public opinion?
- (A) The office of the president
 - (B) The courts
 - (C) Congress
 - (D) The electoral college
 - (E) Political parties
30. Which of the following identifies the formal procedure for ending a filibuster?
- (A) Oversight
 - (B) Logrolling
 - (C) Pocket veto
 - (D) Cloture
 - (E) Discharge petition
31. Which of the following best accounts for the lack of success generally encountered by minor political parties in electing members to the House or Senate?
- (A) Political action committee (PAC) contributions are restricted by law to the two major parties.
 - (B) General elections in the United States are based on the winner-take-all principle.
 - (C) House and Senate rules exclude members of minor parties from organizing coalitions with the major parties.
 - (D) The public has great faith in the two major political parties.
 - (E) Some states outlaw minor political parties.
32. Interest groups are protected under the Constitution by the
- (A) provisions of Article I, Section 8
 - (B) First Amendment
 - (C) Ninth Amendment
 - (D) Tenth Amendment
 - (E) Fourteenth Amendment
33. The Nineteenth Amendment to the Constitution, the Equal Rights Amendment, and Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 were all directed toward the goal of
- (A) protecting the rights of minority children in the schools
 - (B) overcoming discrimination based on sexual orientation
 - (C) racial justice
 - (D) equality for women
 - (E) affirmative action
34. If Congress wanted to effect a change in the Social Security payroll tax, to what congressional committee would the task initially be assigned?
- (A) House Appropriations Committee
 - (B) Senate Appropriations Committee
 - (C) House Ways and Means Committee
 - (D) House Rules Committee
 - (E) Senate Finance Committee

Percent (%) Voting for	Strong Democrat	Weak Democrat	Independent	Weak Republican	Strong Republican
Obama	94	84	58	21	4
McCain	6	16	42	79	96

35. Which of the following statements is supported by the information in the table?
- (A) Strong Democrats were more likely to vote their party identification than were strong Republicans.
 - (B) Independents were less likely to vote than were party identifiers.
 - (C) There was no difference among Independents voting for candidates of either party.
 - (D) Partisanship was a good predictor of the way a person voted.
 - (E) The number of strong Democrats was less than the number of strong Republicans.

36. Which of the following concepts refers to the beliefs about government and politics that people in the United States hold most deeply?
- (A) Ethnic pride
 - (B) Party identification
 - (C) Policy attitude
 - (D) Group identity
 - (E) Political culture
37. The practice in Congress whereby Representative A promises to vote for Representative B's legislation, provided that Representative B will support Representative A's legislation, is referred to as
- (A) personal casework and services
 - (B) partisan discipline
 - (C) logrolling
 - (D) pork barrel legislation
 - (E) filibustering
38. A writ of habeas corpus refers to
- (A) a person's right to know the reasons for his or her imprisonment
 - (B) a person's right to not be charged for an action committed before that action was a crime
 - (C) a person's right to trial by jury
 - (D) the protection against cruel and unusual punishment
 - (E) a demand from one state to extradite a suspect from another state
39. Which of the following is true of voter turnout in the United States?
- (A) Three-fourths of the electorate votes in a presidential election.
 - (B) The South votes in larger numbers than does any other region of the country.
 - (C) Men vote in larger numbers than do women.
 - (D) There is no relationship between the age of the voter and participation rates.
 - (E) The voter-participation rate is one of the lowest of any industrialized nation.
40. Which of the following amendments to the Constitution most likely provides the basis for a driver to challenge the constitutionality of police use of sobriety checkpoints in enforcing drunk driving laws?
- (A) The First Amendment right to petition the government for a redress of grievances
 - (B) The Fourth Amendment protection against unreasonable search and seizure
 - (C) The Fifth Amendment protection against self-incrimination
 - (D) The Eighth Amendment protection against cruel and unusual punishment
 - (E) The Tenth Amendment right of states to powers not given to the national government
41. Which of the following is the main reason interest groups are often successful in getting legislation passed to benefit their members?
- (A) It is easy to garner support from most members of Congress on any issue.
 - (B) All members of society desire the legislation that special interests pursue.
 - (C) It is very easy to get legislation passed in Congress.
 - (D) A narrow constituency derives the benefits from such legislation but the costs are spread broadly across the population.
 - (E) Interest group activity represents the democratic process at work because individual interest groups often represent more than half the population.

42. The Connecticut (Great) Compromise drafted at the Constitutional Convention of 1787 is significant for which of the following reasons?
- (A) It established the presidential system and gave the United States Supreme Court power to serve as the ultimate arbiter of constitutional disputes.
 - (B) It allowed southern states to count each slave as three-fifths of one person for determining representation in the House of Representatives.
 - (C) It provided equality of representation among the states in both the House of Representatives and the Senate.
 - (D) It proposed a Senate with equal representation for each state and a House of Representatives with membership established according to the population of each state.
 - (E) It denied Congress the power to establish tariffs on exported merchandise.
43. The Bipartisan Campaign Reform Act of 2002 (McCain-Feingold) was designed to curtail which of the following?
- (A) Individual contributions to candidates
 - (B) Soft money
 - (C) Hard money
 - (D) Public disclosure rules
 - (E) Lobbying
44. The Americans with Disabilities Act was widely unpopular with governors and mayors because it
- (A) required that people with disabilities be given equal access to public facilities
 - (B) required that buildings be retrofitted or remodeled to give equal access to people with disabilities
 - (C) did not go far enough to establish equal access to public facilities
 - (D) applied only to federal facilities and did nothing to accommodate people in municipal buildings
 - (E) required that states and cities pay for federally mandated construction and remodeling
45. If legislation passes in both the House of Representatives and the Senate but each version is slightly different, the conflicting bills are sent to
- (A) a standing committee of each house for a vote
 - (B) an ad hoc committee for judicial review
 - (C) the Rules Committee of each house for reconciliation and compromise
 - (D) the majority and minority leaders of both houses for compromise
 - (E) a conference committee for review and compromise
46. The United States Constitution says that Congress has the power to coin money. This is an example of
- (A) an enumerated power
 - (B) an implied power
 - (C) an inherent power
 - (D) a reserved power
 - (E) a concurrent power
47. The primary purpose of the North American Free Trade Agreement is to
- (A) strengthen the mutual defense agreements between the countries of western Europe
 - (B) set up a mutual defense agreement between the United States, Mexico, and Canada
 - (C) encourage trade between the United States and the countries of western Europe
 - (D) reduce trade barriers between the United States, Mexico, and Canada
 - (E) set up a system whereby the countries that were formerly part of the Soviet Bloc could be admitted to North Atlantic Treaty Organization
48. Constitutional checks and balances, especially applied to the president, are designed to
- (A) provide for a balanced budget
 - (B) minimize the threat of tyranny from any one branch of government
 - (C) ensure that the states do not become too powerful
 - (D) ensure efficient government
 - (E) ensure that the federal government is militarily strong

49. Civil rights activists, such as those who campaign for gay and lesbian equal rights and those who advocated for racial equality in the 1950s and 1960s, often find the most effective way to secure those rights is
- (A) through mass demonstrations to raise awareness of their cause
 - (B) through lobbying of individual members of Congress for support on legislation
 - (C) through litigation in the courts to gain legal protections against discrimination
 - (D) by launching educational campaigns to increase the level of public support for their cause
 - (E) by persuading presidents to issue executive orders that prevent discrimination within the federal workforce
50. Which of the following is an example of presidential use of informal powers?
- (A) President Ronald Reagan nominating Sandra Day O'Connor to the United States Supreme Court
 - (B) President John F. Kennedy negotiating the Nuclear Test-Ban Treaty with the Soviet Union
 - (C) President Bill Clinton advocating for public policy reform on his Health Security Express bus
 - (D) President George W. Bush deploying United States troops to Iraq
 - (E) President Barack Obama delivering the State of the Union address to Congress
51. Which of the following is NOT a trait of a liberal democracy?
- (A) Holding regular, frequent, and competitive elections
 - (B) Protecting minority rights
 - (C) Having a lively and free press
 - (D) Achieving income equality
 - (E) Guaranteeing equality in voting
52. Which of the following groups would be most likely to support a constitutional amendment banning all abortions?
- (A) Conservatives
 - (B) Libertarians
 - (C) Independents
 - (D) Liberals
 - (E) Moderates
53. Which of the following is true of the relationship between Congress and executive agencies?
- (A) The agencies were created by and work under the direction of Congress.
 - (B) Agencies, once created, work totally independent of Congress.
 - (C) Because the agencies have bureaucratic expertise, Congress delegates "rule-making authority" to them.
 - (D) Because of differing objectives, their relationships are always adversarial.
 - (E) Congress creates, staffs, and supervises all executive agencies.
54. Which of the following is the primary reason for the tensions that exist between the legislative and executive branches of the federal government?
- (A) Each branch sets and approves the other's budget.
 - (B) The branches are staffed with many of the same people.
 - (C) The branches have different constituencies with different interests.
 - (D) The branches are responsible for the selection of Cabinet-level officials.
 - (E) Each branch has the constitutional power to levy taxes.

55. Policy that describes the impact of the federal budget (including taxes, spending, and borrowing) on the economy is referred to as which of the following?
- (A) Monetary policy
 - (B) Trade policy
 - (C) Fiscal policy
 - (D) Antitrust policy
 - (E) Capitalist policy
56. If a college's admission policy to reserve twenty seats in its incoming class for applicants belonging to racial minority groups is challenged in the courts, a judge is likely to
- (A) uphold the policy because it provides additional opportunities for minority applicants
 - (B) strike down the policy because reserving seats amounts to a quota system
 - (C) strike down the policy because the percentage of seats reserved is less than the percentage of minority citizens in the general population
 - (D) uphold the policy because only a small percentage of the total seats for incoming students are affected
 - (E) strike down the policy because it did not apply to women as well as racial minorities
57. When party members meet to nominate a candidate for office, they participate in which of the following?
- (A) General election
 - (B) Caucus
 - (C) Blanket primary
 - (D) Open primary
 - (E) Closed primary
58. Which of the following is an example of the constitutional design of checks and balances?
- (A) The federal government requires state governments to provide unemployment insurance.
 - (B) The Supreme Court overturns a lower court's ruling on the application of the Fourth Amendment.
 - (C) The Senate rejects a president's nomination for secretary of state.
 - (D) The Federal Communications Commission revokes the license of a radio station for hate speech.
 - (E) The Office of Management and Budget rejects a proposed regulation of air quality standards.
59. A difference between the House of Representatives and the Senate is that in the House
- (A) legislative activity on the floor is more constrained by rules
 - (B) committees are less important in the decision-making process
 - (C) junior members have more influence over legislative decisions
 - (D) party leaders are less powerful
 - (E) bills are more likely to be amended on the floor
60. To which level of government did the Bill of Rights originally apply?
- (A) State governments only
 - (B) Federal government only
 - (C) State and federal governments only
 - (D) Local and federal governments only
 - (E) Local, state, and federal governments

UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT AND POLITICS

SECTION II

Time—1 hour and 40 minutes

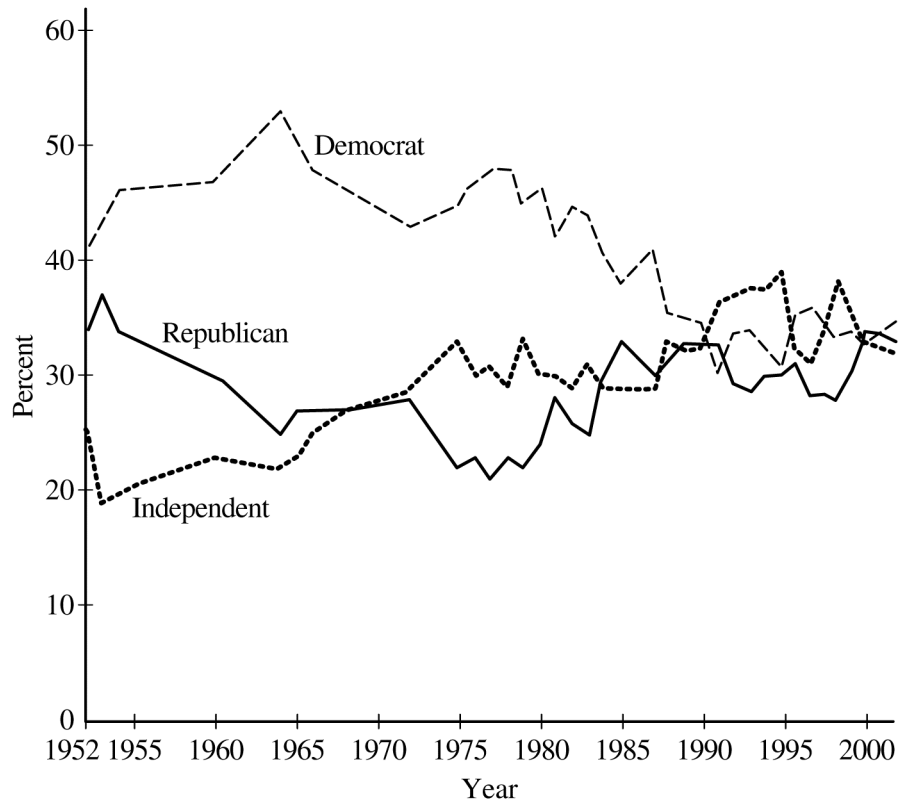
Directions: You have 100 minutes to answer all four of the following questions. Unless the directions indicate otherwise, respond to all parts of all four questions. It is suggested that you take a few minutes to plan and outline each answer. Spend approximately one-fourth of your time (25 minutes) on each question. In your response, use substantive examples where appropriate.

1. The United States Supreme Court has the authority to choose which cases it hears, but its authority is limited in a number of ways.
 - (a) Describe one factor that increases the likelihood for the Supreme Court to accept an appeal.
 - (b) Describe one factor that limits the Supreme Court’s authority to hear cases.
 - (c) Explain how the executive branch can check the authority of the Court.
 - (d) Explain how the legislative branch can check the authority of the Court.
 - (e) Explain how the Court checks the authority of the other branches.

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PARTY IDENTIFICATION OF UNITED STATES VOTERS OVER TIME



2. The graph above reflects changes in party identification over time. These changes have had substantial effects on electoral processes.
- Identify the dominant trend in the graph for independents.
 - Explain two reasons why political parties have declined in importance.
 - Explain two reasons why political parties are still an important part of the electoral process.

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3. The United States Constitution established a bicameral legislature with two distinct chambers.

- Identify one difference between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber, despite unified party control. Explain how this difference accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the same party controls both chambers.
- Identify a second difference between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber, despite unified party control. Explain how this difference accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the same party controls both chambers.
- Identify a third difference between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber, despite unified party control. Explain how this difference accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the same party controls both chambers.

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**Answer Key for AP United States Government and Politics
Practice Exam, Section I**

Question 1: E	Question 31: B
Question 2: D	Question 32: B
Question 3: D	Question 33: D
Question 4: B	Question 34: C
Question 5: D	Question 35: D
Question 6: B	Question 36: E
Question 7: A	Question 37: C
Question 8: D	Question 38: A
Question 9: D	Question 39: E
Question 10: E	Question 40: B
Question 11: B	Question 41: D
Question 12: B	Question 42: D
Question 13: A	Question 43: B
Question 14: A	Question 44: E
Question 15: C	Question 45: E
Question 16: E	Question 46: A
Question 17: A	Question 47: D
Question 18: A	Question 48: B
Question 19: C	Question 49: C
Question 20: D	Question 50: C
Question 21: B	Question 51: D
Question 22: A	Question 52: A
Question 23: E	Question 53: C
Question 24: A	Question 54: C
Question 25: B	Question 55: C
Question 26: A	Question 56: B
Question 27: C	Question 57: B
Question 28: C	Question 58: C
Question 29: B	Question 59: A
Question 30: D	Question 60: B

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2013 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1

5 points

Part (a): 1 point

One point is earned for a description of one factor that increases the likelihood for the Supreme Court to accept an appeal.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Cases heard by lower federal courts/State Supreme Courts that have discrepancies/ inconsistencies in their decisions
- Cases dealing with a constitutional issue
- Cases with a pattern of concern/percolation of an issue
- Cases involving the federal government/Solicitor General

Part (b): 1 point

One point is earned for a description of one factor that limits the Supreme Court's authority to hear cases.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- The Supreme Court must be petitioned to hear a case
- State cases must be about a constitutional/federal issue
- Federal cases must be within appellate or original jurisdiction

Part (c): 1 point

One point is earned for an explanation of how the executive branch can check the authority of the Court.

Acceptable executive checks' include:

- Appointments that forward a President's ideology or philosophy
- Lack of enforcement of court decisions
- Executive Orders that circumvent the Supreme Court

Part (d): 1 point

One point is earned for an explanation of how the legislative branch can check the authority of the Court.

Acceptable legislative checks' include:

- Limit the funding of implications of the Court's decisions
- Legislation to circumvent Supreme Court decisions
- Propose an amendment to reverse Supreme Court decisions
- Impeachment of Justices (threat)
- Control the appellate jurisdiction of the Supreme Court

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2013 SCORING GUIDELINES**

Question 1 (continued)

Part (e): 1 point

One point is earned for an explanation of how the Supreme Court uses **judicial review** to check the legislative and/or executive branches.

Note: In points (c), (d), and (e), in order to receive the explanation point, the student must explain how the authority of the Supreme Court or the branches of government has been checked.

A score of zero (0) is assigned to answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

A score of dash (-) is assigned to answer that is blank.

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Question 2

5 points

Part (a): 1 point

One point is earned for correctly identifying the trend in the graph that Independents have increased over time.

Part (b): 2 points

One point is earned for each of two explanations of why political parties have decreased in importance.

Acceptable reasons include:

- Increase in direct primaries/decrease in party caucuses
- Increase in candidate-centered campaigns
- Increase in interest groups support causes displacement of traditional parties functions
- Change in campaign finance laws/increase in super PACs which are outside of party control
- Change in media coverage (negative or lack of coverage) of the parties
- Alienation from parties
- Decrease in trust of parties

Part (c): 2 points

One point is earned for each of two explanations of why political parties are still an important part of the electoral process.

Acceptable reasons include:

- providing cues for voters
- mobilizing voters
- funding candidates
- recruiting candidates
- advertising for candidates
- nominating candidates/running primaries or caucuses
- controlling ballot access for candidates

A score of zero (0) is assigned to answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

A score of dash (-) is assigned to answer that is blank.

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Question 3

6 points

Part (a) 2 points

One point is earned for a correct **identification** of one difference between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber, despite unified party control. One point is earned for a correct **explanation** of how this difference accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the same party controls both chambers.

Part (b) 2 points

One point is earned for a second correct **identification** of one difference between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber, despite unified party control. One point is earned for a correct **explanation** of how this difference accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the same party controls both chambers.

Part (c) 2 points

One point is earned for a third correct **identification** of one difference between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber, despite unified party control. One point is earned for a correct **explanation** of how this difference accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the same party controls both chambers.

Acceptable identifications of differences between the House and Senate that contributes to legislation passing in only one chamber include:

- House is more formal /Senate is less formal or more collegial
- Greater workload in the Senate slows the flow of legislation
- Harder to get a majority in House
- Senate members are less frequently preoccupied than House members about reelection
- Filibuster
- House Rules Committee
- Unanimous consent or Holds
- Different constituencies
- Powers of presiding officers/speakers
- Germaneness of Riders
- Greater specialization in the House

For each part, the student must explain how the difference identified accounts for legislation passing in only one chamber, even when the party controls both chambers.

A score of zero (0) is assigned to answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

A score of dash (-) is assigned to answer that is blank.

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Question 4

5 points

Part (a) 1 point

One point is earned for a correct **definition** of a budget deficit being the shortfall between revenue and spending.

Part (b) 1 point

One point is earned for a correct example of an entitlement program.

Acceptable examples include:

- Medicare
- Medicaid
- Social Security
- TANF
- Veteran's Benefits

Note: This is not an exhaustive list.

Part (c) 2 points

One point is earned for a correct **definition** of entitlements being government sponsored programs providing mandated/guaranteed/required benefits to those who meet eligibility requirements/qualifications.

A second point is earned for an **explanation of why** the program identified in (b) makes it difficult to control federal spending.

Acceptable explanations include:

- Cannot be taken away unless by legislation or due process
- Mandatory/ Uncontrollable
- Difficult to alter because it requires a change in law/not sunset laws
- Funds politically popular programs
- Funds fastest growing segments of population/ increasing number who are eligible
- Costs dramatically increasing (Medicare/Medicaid/Social Security/TANF)

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Question 4 (continued)

Part (d) 1 point

One point is earned for a correct **description** of a proposal other than reducing spending that would reduce the federal budget deficit.

Acceptable descriptions include:

- Increasing revenue/raising taxes/eliminating tax loopholes
- Altering means test
- Changing eligibility requirements

A score of zero (0) is assigned to answer that is completely off task or is on task but earns no points.

A score of dash (-) is assigned to answer that is blank.